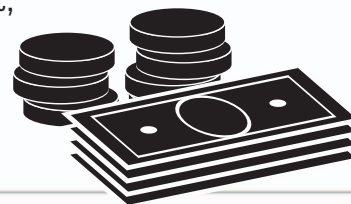




TRADER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Traders are employed by financial institutions—such as investment banks—to trade investments by buying and selling them on the world's financial markets. These trades are made on behalf of individuals, companies, or institutional investors, such as pension funds and banks. Traders work in a fast-paced environment, using their judgment and experience to create a profit for their clients.



SALARY

New trader ★★☆☆☆

Senior trader ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Highly competitive industry • Financial rewards, particularly bonuses, are potentially substantial • Jobs available across the world

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Economics • Finance • Mathematics • Financial markets • Accountancy • Business studies • Information Technology (IT)



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree or higher is required; employers favor subjects related to business, finance, or mathematics.



LIFESTYLE Traders work long hours every day to track movements in markets around the world. Much of the work is screen-based.



LOCATION Traders work in an office. Most job opportunities exist in the world's major financial centers, such as New York, London, and Tokyo.



THE REALITIES The job can be very demanding and stressful. Traders must excel in a fiercely competitive and pressurized work environment.

CAREER PATHS

Prospective traders must pass a rigorous recruitment process that may include aptitude and personality tests. Most entrants then spend two years working in a junior trading role and studying for professional qualifications. With experience, they may manage a team of traders in a particular type of financial market, or specialize in a specific trading area.

GRADUATE Due to strong competition for jobs, you need high grades in an undergraduate degree in a technical, financial, or business-related subject when applying for jobs as a trader.



POSTGRADUATE You can increase your chances of becoming a trader by gaining a higher degree in a subject such as economics, finance, mathematics, or business.

